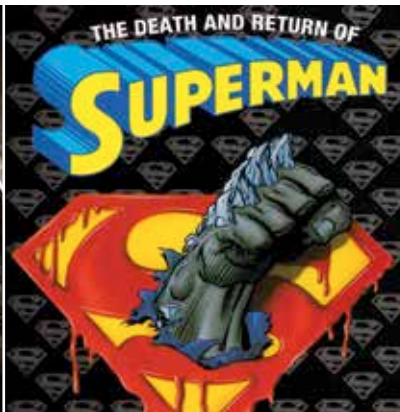




nothing to do with the main company itself. The excellent X-Men Legends was probably the last good X-Men game with the movie tie-in, with the Wolverine: Origins coming in at a close second. The underwhelming Marvel: Ultimate Alliance wasn't completely unplayable but it did not set the gaming world on fire. But then again, this can all be traced back to the mis-handling of characters. Exactly what's going on with the MCU? But enough about Marvel games, what about the good folks over at DC/Warner Media?

The guys over at Warner do treat their properties with a little more respect than Marvel does which is why they're the only bastion for decent games. Although, DC does have its fair share of duds as well. Back on the PS2, we got a Justice League game that was very similar to the Marvel Ultimate Alliance formula but was just better written and had its characters based on the wildly successful designs of Bruce Timm from the DC animated universe. The company does not have the best record when it comes to games but has, over the years, tried bringing its much-loved characters to the gaming world. Apart from the steaming pile of dung that was Superman 64 and Aquaman for the N64, DC has tried its best at delivering fun experiences. The 2D action of the SNES era saw a ton of DC games hit the console. From the Death of Superman to Justice League

Task Force, the console was home to a bunch of games that followed a similar beat 'em-up style. It wasn't until Rocksteady's Arkham series did we actually get a AAA superhero game that did not suck! Arkham Asylum changed the way we looked at superhero games and gave us a dark, gritty adventure starring the caped



crusader and his extended Bat-family. The sequel was an even bigger success, expanding the world to include Gotham City and then introducing the tank-like Batmobile in Arkham Knight. To see a studio like Rocksteady fall so far from grace is quite sad, really. Suicide Squad looks so generic and boring that this writer will probably not even play the game. I've loved these characters and can't bear to see how they destroy them.

On another personal note, why are all these superhero costumes so overdesigned? It's like they all tried to copy the god-awful designs of Horizon Zero Dawn. The new Suicide

Squad just looks too over-designed with even classic villains like King Shark looking like they walked into a Brazilian parade! It's so distracting that it turns me off from even playing the game. I booted up Forbidden West on the PS5 and in 5 minutes I had enough. The costumes and design were so distraining and pulled me out of the world. Maybe it's just me but I prefer the sleek look of the Batman as compared to the rainbow colour scheme found in games like Zero Dawn and now the Suicide Squad.

As superheroes become even more mainstream, we're starting to see the sharks circling their prey. Predatory practices like games as a live service, loot boxes and the dreaded Battle Pass have all made their way into the world of superhero games and we're worse off for it. There doesn't seem to be any hope on the horizon as companies dig their sticky fingers deeper into the genre. Marvel has already been leashed by the geniuses at Disney and Warner Media has their own issues, like bankruptcy to worry about. The only hope we have is the new Hellboy game but even then, it really is just the indie studios picking up the slack. As a fan of comics and superheroes, it's painful to watch the death rattle of the genre but as with all good things in life, they must come to an unceremonious corporate end. *